

Conversation

#20

CONVERSATION

WEEKEND PLANS IN SÃO PAULO – TOO MANY OPTIONS, NOT ENOUGH TIME

Prepare 8 pieces of paper numbered from 1 to 8 and have each student draw one to discover their character.

This activity focuses on **making plans, negotiating preferences, handling disagreement, and managing time and money.**

It's Friday evening in São Paulo.

A group of close friends who live in the city is deciding **what to do over the weekend.**

São Paulo offers endless options — but time, money, energy, and distance are limited.

Traffic, weather, and personal priorities all play a role.

What starts as a relaxed conversation turns into tension when everyone realizes they **can't do everything.**

The group must choose **one main plan** and accept trade-offs.

Weekend Options in São Paulo

Option	Activity	When	Cost (avg.)
Paulista Avenue walk	Coffee, street art, museums	Saturday afternoon	R\$ 40
Vila Madalena	Bars & nightlife	Saturday night	R\$ 120
Ibirapuera Park	Walking, biking, picnic	Saturday or Sunday	R\$ 20
Shopping mall	Movies + food court	Saturday	R\$ 80
Live show	Concert or stand-up	Saturday night	R\$ 150
Sunday brunch	Bakery or café	Sunday morning	R\$ 60
Staying home	Streaming & rest	Weekend	R\$ 0
Short trip	Santos or interior (day trip)	Sunday	R\$ 200

Student Coaching – How to Use the Information

- Defend **one preferred plan** using real-life reasons (traffic, cost, distance)
- React to other people's ideas politely or emotionally
- Say **yes, no, or maybe** with justification
- Remember: choosing one plan means **giving up another**

Characters

1. Jason – The Planner

"I like to decide things early. São Paulo is stressful enough without last-minute plans.

Traffic, reservations, timing — everything matters here. If we don't decide now, the weekend disappears.

I want a clear plan."

2. Rachel – The Social One

“I live in São Paulo for the energy. Staying home feels like wasting the city.
Bars, music, people — that’s my vibe. I don’t want a quiet weekend.
I’ll push for nightlife.”

3. Mike – The Tired One

“This week destroyed me. Traffic, work, noise — I need a break.
Crowded places drain me. A calm weekend sounds perfect.
I don’t want pressure.”

4. Emily – The Balanced One

“I want to enjoy the city, but not exhaust myself. Doing too much in São Paulo is a mistake.
I’m trying to balance fun and rest.
One good plan is better than many rushed ones.
I want something reasonable.”

5. Kevin – The Budget-Conscious Friend

“São Paulo is expensive. If we’re not careful, one weekend kills my budget.
I don’t want to feel embarrassed saying no. Cost matters to me.
I need an affordable option.”

6. Laura – The Outdoor Lover

“This city is concrete. If I don’t see green, I feel trapped.
Parks and open spaces save my mental health. Malls and bars don’t excite me.
I’ll argue for Ibirapuera or a day trip.”

7. Daniel – The Easygoing Friend

“I like São Paulo because there’s always something to do. Honestly, I can adapt.
But I hate conflict. When people argue, I stop talking.
I’ll try to keep peace.”

8. Olivia – The Realist

“We live in São Paulo — traffic and rain decide for us. We can’t do everything.
Someone will be unhappy, and that’s okay. What matters is choosing and enjoying it.
Let’s be honest and decide.”

Guide your writing:

- 1 Describe the situation and options.
- 2 Explain the different opinions.
- 3 Describe the final decision.
- 4 End with one lesson about compromise or city life.

Length: 120–150 words

Tone: personal and reflective

Title:

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.